GREEN CAMPUS

Visual: project identity graphic generated from the supplied project list. Official project images are available through the source links below.

Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project addresses the difficulty of scaling low-energy and healthy-building principles beyond a single dwelling. It had to combine density or phased delivery with reliable energy performance, good indoor conditions, landscape quality, mobility and construction cost, while keeping the sustainability measures practical for many future occupants.

Solution

The response combines green façades and an intensive green roof that add vegetation to a dense urban site; zero-VOC paint, environmentally preferable materials and LED lighting in common spaces; and energy-regenerative lifts and a separate collection system for five waste streams. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The approach can be scaled through repeatable specifications for envelope, MEP systems, materials, commissioning, mobility and landscape. Replication is strongest when the developer applies the same measurable requirements to every phase and verifies them at handover, rather than treating certification as a one-off design exercise.

Key facts and figures

Location	Strada Teodor Mihali 3T-6T, Cluj-Napoca, Romania
Building use / function	Multi-family residential complex
Project type (new build, refurbishment, extension)	New build
Plot area / Floor area	Approximately 13,440-15,000 m²; 191-192 apartments depending on source
Year / phase	Completed and certified in 2014
Climate zone	Humid continental
Thematic focus / innovation	First-mover green housing; green façade and roof; low-VOC materials; efficient lifts and lighting; five-stream waste separation
Investor / building owner	Studium Green
Architect	Not publicly disclosed in the consulted sources
Other involved stakeholders	Romania Green Building Council; Knauf Insulation and other solution providers; landscape and MEP teams
Contact person	Studium Green - https://studiumgreen.ro/
Further information	https://green-homes.org/property/green-campus/ https://www.rogbc.org/proiecte-certificate-rogbc?lang=en https://www.rogbc.org/_files/ugd/40ee3e_b5d91d7a3b71422cb98cd7a289b89c79.pdf

Green Campus is a new build project in Strada Teodor Mihali 3T-6T, Cluj-Napoca, Romania. It functions as multi-family residential complex. Its main best-practice contribution is Widely cited as the first Romanian residential complex designed and built to comprehensive green-building criteria. The documented strategy brings together green façades and an intensive green roof that add vegetation to a dense urban site, zero-VOC paint, environmentally preferable materials and LED lighting in common spaces, and energy-regenerative lifts and a separate collection system for five waste streams. Public sources differ slightly on total area and apartment count; both describe the same completed 2014 project. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - Green façades and an intensive green roof that add vegetation to a dense urban site.
2. Integrated systems and operation - Zero-voc paint, environmentally preferable materials and led lighting in common spaces.
3. Wider value - Energy-regenerative lifts and a separate collection system for five waste streams.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of truth.